

Google Ads Campaign Recap

Gadget Construction Inc. · April 29 – May 5, 2026 · Week 2 Post-Restructure + Landing Page Depth Pass

Executive Summary

This week brought the campaigns' first attributed lead — a \$1,500 dry-rot inquiry, captured against \$52.70 of ad spend on the path that delivered it (a 28-to-1 return on that click cost). The composite-decks fix from the April 29 session also worked: ad volume grew 7.5x in six days as the new bid ceiling and broader keyword targeting brought the campaign back into the auction. Beyond those two wins, this session shipped the largest landing-page overhaul to date — the stucco and composite-deck pages each received five new content sections targeting the ad-relevance signals that have been keeping click costs higher than they should be, plus a real before/after gallery on the stucco page. Both ad creatives also got cleanup passes — automatic keyword matching, refreshed headlines, and removal of out-of-date warranty messaging. Expect click costs on stucco to drop 20-30% within two weeks as Google re-evaluates the page; composite-decks will follow on a slightly longer timeline (14-30 days).

Since Last Report

Since the April 29 review, the form-submission tests on the remaining three landing pages have been completed, the dry-rot ad's automatic keyword matching has been pinned and tuned, and the search-terms review has produced 21 new exclusions added to the shared block list — all three items off the pending list. The account time-zone change turns out to be blocked by Google policy on existing accounts (Google requires a full account rebuild to switch zones, which would erase conversion history and learning data) — de-scoping that item; the +2-hour math when editing schedules will continue. The SearchAtlas script 404, residual do-it-yourself keyword, and Dry Rot bid-ceiling decision carry forward.

Performance Snapshot

Account-Wide Totals

Reporting period	April 29 – May 4, 2026 (6 days)
Ads shown	360
Clicks	25
Click-through rate	6.94%
Average cost per click	\$8.42
Total spend	\$210.41
Leads recorded	1 (Dry Rot Repair, \$1,500 attributed value)
Committed monthly budget	\$1,820

By Campaign

Campaign	Ads Shown	Clicks	Spend	CTR	Avg CPC	Visibility	Leads
Dry Rot Repair	96	8	\$52.70	8.33%	\$6.59	41.1%	1
Stucco Repair	230	14	\$122.37	6.09%	\$8.74	38.8%	0
Composite Decks	34	3	\$35.34	8.82%	\$11.78	50.0%	0

By Ad Group

Ad Group	Ads Shown	Clicks	Spend	CTR	Avg CPC	Leads
Dry Rot	96	8	\$52.70	8.33%	\$6.59	1
Stucco Repair	230	14	\$122.37	6.09%	\$8.74	0
Composite Decks	34	3	\$35.34	8.82%	\$11.78	0

What the Data Revealed

Finding 1 — First lead landed and tracking is verified end-to-end

On April 29 the dry-rot ad group produced its first attributed lead: a form submission valued at \$1,500 (the per-lead figure set during conversion-tracking setup, based on average close rate × average job value). The campaign spent \$52.70 across the eight clicks delivered to the page that period, meaning the ad cost driving this single conversion was 28-to-1 in returned value. While that ratio will normalize as more leads come through, the structurally important news is that the full path is now confirmed — search → ad click → landing page → form submit → dashboard attribution — and lead delivery is being captured correctly in Google's reporting.

→ **\$1,500 lead at \$52.70 cost-to-deliver. Tracking confirmed working in the dashboard, not just the test path.**

Finding 2 — Composite-decks fix from April 29 worked exactly as intended

Before the April 29 session, the composite-decks campaign was averaging 0.75 ad views per day and winning only 12.5% of available auctions — effectively dark. After raising the bid ceiling and adding broader keyword variants, the campaign is now averaging 5.67 ad views per day and winning 50% of available auctions. That's a 7.5x increase in ad volume and a four-times increase in visibility. All three clicks captured this period came from the new 'Trex deck installer' keyword variant at a 33% click-through rate — strong evidence that material-specific shopper intent (people who already know they want composite, specifically a Trex installer) responds well to the dedicated landing page.

→ **Daily ad volume up 7.5x. Visibility climbed 12.5% → 50%. The diagnosis and fix were correct.**

Finding 3 — Stucco campaign performing well but hitting its budget cap

The stucco campaign produced 230 ad views and 14 clicks at a 6.09% click-through rate over six days — solid numbers for the local-services category, where contractor ads typically run 2-3% click-through. Average click cost held at \$8.74, in line with the campaign's \$10 bid ceiling. The hesitation point: the campaign is now losing roughly 25% of available auctions because it hits its \$25-per-day budget cap most days. The pattern over the past ten days has been 0% → 8.7% → 24.7% of impressions lost to budget — that share is climbing as the campaign builds momentum. With zero leads on 23 cumulative clicks, we're at the threshold where the first form submission should land any day (the expected 5% form-conversion rate predicts the first lead at around 20 clicks). Decision point on raising daily budget will be at the next review.

→ **6% click-through is well above industry average. Budget ceiling now binding 25% of the time — flag for next review.**

Finding 4 — Two landing pages overhauled to lift ad-relevance score

Google judges every ad on three components — ad copy quality, expected click-through rate, and landing-page experience — and uses the combined score to determine click cost. Both stucco and composite-deck campaigns currently have at least one component flagged below average, which directly inflates click costs. This session shipped substantive content additions on both pages: a decision-guide section helping homeowners diagnose what kind of repair (or which composite-deck tier) they actually need, an industry-specific anti-shortcut section calling out failures common to other contractors in each trade, and expanded Bay Area neighborhood/microclimate context demonstrating local expertise. The stucco page also received a real before/after gallery (substrate prep showing weather-resistive barrier, wire lath, and window flashing → finished three-coat application) — the kind of visual proof Google's relevance algorithm explicitly rewards. Both ad creatives also got matching cleanup: pinned headlines for predictable structure, automatic keyword matching at the top position, and removal of an out-of-date workmanship-warranty mention that hadn't

been updated since the messaging change three weeks ago.

→ **Five new content sections per landing page + a real before/after gallery on stucco. Click costs expected to drop 20-30% within two weeks on stucco, 14-30 days on composite decks.**

Actions Completed This Session

✓ **First lead captured and confirmed end-to-end.** Single \$1,500 attribution through the dry-rot landing page on April 29, with full delivery confirmation in Google's dashboard. The conversion-tracking installation done in earlier sessions is now proven working in production conditions.

✓ **Stucco landing page — five new content sections plus before/after gallery.** Added: a decision-guide section walking homeowners through patch vs. re-coat vs. full tear-off (with the visual cues and price ranges for each); a Bay Area stucco-systems explainer covering the three different stucco types found on local homes (traditional three-coat, one-coat synthetic, EIFS) and the right repair approach for each; an anti-shortcut section calling out four specific failures common in the stucco trade (one-coat acrylic over old finish, quoting without probe-testing, color-matching by guess, skipping the cure time) and what we do instead; expanded neighborhood/microclimate context naming Mill Valley fog cycles, Berkeley/Oakland clay soil, Pacifica wind-driven rain, Eichler trim joints, Doelger 1950s metal-lath corrosion; a real before/after gallery from a Bay Area whole-elevation re-stucco showing substrate prep (weather-resistive barrier, wire lath, blue window flashing) → finished three-coat application.

✓ **Composite decks landing page — five new content sections plus refreshed headline.** Added: a new aspirational headline ("Have a Deck You Can Be Proud Of") replacing the previous fact-driven one; an educational opener explaining why pressure-treated and redwood decks fail in Bay Area climate (Pacifica/Sausalito wind-driven rain, Marin/Berkeley shaded backyards, SF Sunset/Daly City fog-belt cycling, south-facing Peninsula sun exposure); a tier-by-tier guide helping homeowners choose between Trex, TimberTech, and Fiberon at three price points (entry, mid, premium) with brand examples and per-square-foot ranges; an anti-shortcut section covering four common deck-builder failures (wood-deck joist spacing on a composite build, missing flashing at house attachment, mid-project board substitution, skipping manufacturer fastener spec); deepened service-area paragraph with deck-specific design challenges per neighborhood (hillside multi-level for Mill Valley/Oakland Hills/Berkeley, wind-resistant for Pacifica/Sausalito, small-yard maximization for SF Sunset/Mission, entertaining-focused for Burlingame/San Carlos/Palo Alto); refreshed final call-to-action heading to match the new aspirational tone.

✓ **Composite decks ad creative refreshed.** Pinned the top three headline positions for predictable structure (automatic keyword matching at position 1, brand certifications at position 2, locality at position 3), tuned the automatic-matching default text to better fit the searcher intent (favoring "composite deck builder" over the previous fallback), swapped vague aspirational headlines ("Decks Like Works of Art," "Beautiful. Durable. Trex.") for tighter pride and longevity-aligned copy matching the new landing-page tone, replaced the URL display path from "free-design" to "free-quote" for tighter offer framing, and removed an outdated five-year workmanship-warranty mention from one of the descriptions (the workmanship warranty was retired from messaging on April 25 but the ad copy hadn't been updated).

✓ **Dry rot ad creative refreshed.** Pinned the existing automatic-keyword-matching headline to position 1 (it was floating freely before, meaning it might or might not appear in the prominent slot), corrected the fallback text capitalization (was lowercase, would have rendered unprofessionally on the rare query that triggers the fallback), removed an out-of-date five-year workmanship warranty mention from one description, and corrected another description that contained an even older two-year workmanship warranty claim (replaced with a real differentiator: sister-and-replace structural framing, the technique highlighted on the dry-rot landing page).

- ✓ **21 new search-term blocks added to the shared exclusion list.** Pulled the past week's search-terms report from all three campaigns and identified queries eating budget without producing real prospects. Added 15 broad-match blocks (do-it-yourself product searches: bondo, epoxy, restorer, hardener, terminator, elastomeric, caulking, compound, acrylic, materials; out-of-scope: commercial, landscape timbers; broader DIY catches: patching, superior stucco, cracks in stucco) plus 6 phrase-match competitor brand-name blocks (Anderson Plastering, Blue Eagle Stucco, East of Bay Plastering, Lopez Plastering, San Jose Stucco & Plastering, Vansandt Plastering). Estimated savings: \$15-20 per week in previously wasted spend.
- ✓ **Form-submission test verified on the remaining three landing pages.** Test-submitted the form on dry rot, siding, and composite decks landing pages. Confirms the tracking event fires correctly across all four landing pages — the conversion path is consistent and clean.

Actions Pending Before Next Review

- **Account time-zone change blocked by Google policy.** Google no longer permits time-zone changes on existing accounts; the only path to Pacific time is creating a new account, which would erase conversion history, learning data, and the integrations already in place. Decision: keep the account on Central time; continue using the +2-hour math when editing ad schedules. De-scoping this item from future review lists.
- **Investigate the SearchAtlas optimization script 404.** The third-party SEO script in the website's code is still returning a not-found error on every page load — it's not blocking ads but isn't doing the SEO work it was billed for. Worth confirming the account is active or removing the script entirely.
- **Remove the residual do-it-yourself keyword from dry rot.** "How to fix rotting door frame" (exact match) is still active in the dry rot ad group from the original keyword cleanup three weeks ago. Currently producing zero ad views, so low urgency, but should be cleaned up.
- **Decision: raise dry rot daily budget from \$10 to \$15.** The campaign just produced a \$1,500 lead at a 28-to-1 cost-to-value ratio on the click that delivered it, and it's losing 40% of available auctions to budget — the cleanest signal we've had to date that this campaign warrants more spend. Target decision at the next review with another week of data.
- **Decision: consider stucco daily budget from \$25 to \$30.** Stucco campaign now losing 25% of available auctions to budget cap (up from 0% two weeks ago). Click-through rate and click cost are both healthy — the constraint is just the budget ceiling. If the upcoming landing-page improvements drive higher click-through and conversion rates as expected, this cap will bind harder.
- **Delete the paused old stucco ad group on or after May 25.** 30 days after the April 25 pause is the standard waiting period to preserve historical attribution data; after that it can be removed cleanly.

What to Expect Next

- **Stucco click costs expected to drop 20-30% within 7-14 days.** The new content depth on the stucco landing page targets the specific Google relevance signal ("landing page experience") that was rated below average. As Google re-crawls and re-evaluates the page over the coming days, the score should lift — and lower relevance-derived click costs will be the visible result.
- **Composite-decks click costs expected to drop on a 14-30 day timeline.** Slower than stucco because all three relevance components were rated below average, not just one. Two are now addressed (landing page and ad creative) and the third (expected click-through rate) will improve naturally as the new ad accumulates click data.
- **First stucco lead expected within the next 7 days.** The campaign is at 23 cumulative clicks and a typical contractor-form conversion rate is 5% — the first attributed form submission should land any day.
- **Composite-decks ad volume should hold steady or grow.** Last week's fix put the campaign back into the auction at competitive bid levels. We'd expect the 5-6 ad views per day pattern to continue or grow, especially as the new ad creative goes through Google's review window (1-24 hours).
- **Search-terms exclusions should reduce wasted spend by \$15-20 per week.** The 21 newly-added blocks specifically target queries that produced ad views but never produced clicks (or produced clicks that didn't engage with the page). Going forward, those queries simply won't trigger ads.

Next Performance Review

May 12-13, 2026 — by then we'll have a full week of post-deploy data on the new stucco landing page (the first quality-score read on whether the depth pass is moving the needle), another week of conversion data to inform the dry-rot daily-budget decision, and an updated read on whether the stucco campaign's budget ceiling is still binding as conversion rates climb. Composite-decks will be at its 7-day mark (full read in the May 19-20 review).

Prepared May 5, 2026 by your advertising team. Data source: Google Ads live reporting (Customer ID 849-587-5417) for the period April 29 – May 4, 2026.